Cloudflare deployment playbook: www.exterprise.us

Goal: serve the new Exterprise website from Cloudflare at **https://www.exterprise.us**, with no downtime for the website or email.

Time: about 60–90 minutes of work, plus up to 24 hours waiting for DNS (usually under 1 hour).

Who: one person with access to the domain registrar, the GitHub organization **XVOXLABS**, and a company email address for the Cloudflare account.

Tick each ☐ as you go. Lines marked ✔ **You should see** tell you what success looks like. If the screen doesn't match, stop and check that step.

Cloudflare occasionally renames menu items. If a label differs slightly, look for the closest match; the order of the steps stays the same.

Fill in before you start

Item	Value
Domain registrar (where exterprise.us was bought)	
Registrar login owner	
Cloudflare account email (company address)	
GitHub user with admin access to XVOXLABS	
Planned go-live time (quiet hours)	
Old `www` record (type and value), filled in at Part 10	
Old `@` record (type and value), filled in at Part 10	

Part 1. Record the current DNS (at your registrar)

Nothing changes in this part. You're only writing things down.

☐ **1.1** Sign in to your domain registrar.

☐ **1.2** Open the DNS settings for **exterprise.us**:

- **GoDaddy: My Products** → next to *exterprise.us* click **DNS**

- **Namecheap: Domain List** → *exterprise.us* → **Manage** → **Advanced DNS**
- **Squarespace / Google Domains: Domains** → *exterprise.us* → **DNS** → **DNS settings**
- **Other registrars:** find **DNS**, **DNS Management** or **Zone Editor**

☐ **1.3** Take a screenshot (or use **Export**) of **every** record on the page. Scroll down so nothing is missed.

☐ **1.4** Highlight these in your screenshot. They keep email working:

- every **MX** record
- **TXT** records starting `v=spf1`, plus any named `_dmarc` or `google-site-verification`
- **CNAME** records such as `autodiscover`, `selector1._domainkey`, `selector2._domainkey` and `mail`

☐ **1.5** Find **DNSSEC** (often under *DNS*, *Security* or *Advanced*) and note whether it's **On** or **Off**. Don't change it yet.

> ✔ **You should see:** a complete picture of the current records, saved somewhere safe.

Part 2. Create the Cloudflare account

☐ **2.1** Go to **https://dash.cloudflare.com/sign-up**.

☐ **2.2** Enter the **company email** (not a personal one) and a strong password → **Sign up**.

☐ **2.3** Open the verification email from Cloudflare → click **Verify email**.

☐ **2.4** Turn on two-factor authentication:

1. Click the **person icon** (top right) → **Profile** → **Authentication**.
2. Under **Two-Factor Authentication**, click **Set up / Enable** and follow the steps with an authenticator app.
3. **Save the backup codes.**

☐ **2.5** Add a second admin so access never depends on one person:

1. Click the **account name** (top left) → **Manage account** → **Members** → **Invite**.
2. Enter their email → role **Super Administrator** → **Invite**.

> ✔ **You should see:** the Cloudflare dashboard home page, with 2FA shown as enabled.

Part 3. Add exterprise.us to Cloudflare

☐ **3.1** On the dashboard home, click **+ Add** (top right) → **Connect a domain**. On some accounts this is **Add a domain** on the home page.

☐ **3.2** Type `exterprise.us` (no `www`).

☐ **3.3** Leave **Quick scan for DNS records** selected → **Continue**.

☐ **3.4** Choose the **Free** plan (scroll to the bottom of the plan list) → **Continue** / **Select plan**.

> ✔ **You should see:** a **Review your DNS records** page listing records Cloudflare copied from your current DNS.

Part 4. Check the copied DNS records

Still no change for visitors. The old nameservers stay in charge until Part 8.

☐ **4.1** Compare this list with your screenshot from Part 1, **line by line**.

☐ **4.2** For any record that's missing:

1. Click **+ Add record**.
2. Choose the **Type** (MX, TXT, CNAME and so on) and copy **Name**, **Content / Target** and **Priority** (for MX) exactly.
3. Click **Save**.

☐ **4.3** Make every email-related record grey (**DNS only**). This includes `mail`, `autodiscover`, `*._domainkey`, `smtp`, `imap` and similar:

1. Click **Edit** on the record.
2. Switch **Proxy status** off, so the cloud turns **grey**.
3. Click **Save**.

MX and TXT records have no proxy switch, which is fine.

☐ **4.4** Leave the existing `@` (or `exterprise.us`) and `www` records **as they are**. They still point at the old website.

☐ **4.5** Click **Continue to activation** / **Continue**.

☐ **4.6** Cloudflare now shows **two nameservers**, for example `abby.ns.cloudflare.com` and `kyle.ns.cloudflare.com`. **Copy both exactly.** You need them in Part 8. Leave this tab open.

> ✔ **You should see:** a page titled something like **Update your nameservers**, with your two Cloudflare nameservers.

Part 5. Connect GitHub and deploy the site

☐ **5.1** In the left sidebar, click **Compute (Workers)** → **Workers & Pages**. On older menus it's just **Workers & Pages**.

☐ **5.2** Click **Create** (or **Create application**).

☐ **5.3** On the **Workers** tab, choose **Import a repository** → **Get started**.

☐ **5.4** Click **Connect GitHub** (or **+ Add account** → **GitHub**). A GitHub window opens:

1. Sign in with the GitHub user that has admin access to **XVOXLABS**.
2. Choose **Install** for the **XVOXLABS** organization.
3. Select **Only select repositories** → **Exterprise**.
4. Click **Install & Authorize**.

☐ **5.5** Back in Cloudflare, select **XVOXLABS / Exterprise** → **Next** / **Begin setup**.

☐ **5.6** Fill in **Configure your project**:

Field	Enter
Project name	`exterprise` (must be exactly this; it matches `wrangler.jsonc`)
Production branch	`main`
Build command	*leave empty*
Deploy command	`npx wrangler deploy`
Non-production branch deploy command	`npx wrangler versions upload`
Path / Root directory (under *Advanced settings*)	`/`
API token	leave as **Create new token** (Cloudflare does this for you)

☐ **5.7** Click **Create and deploy** (or **Save and Deploy**).

☐ **5.8** Wait 1–3 minutes, watching the build log. Near the end, the log should include:

```
[custom build] dist: 254 files, style.css?v=…, site.js?v=…
✨ Success! Uploaded … files
Deployed exterprise triggers
  https://exterprise.<your-account>.workers.dev
```

✔ **You should see:** a green **Success** / **Deployed** status and a `https://exterprise.<your-account>.workers.dev` address. Copy that address.

If the build fails: open the log, scroll to the first red line, and send it to the developer. The usual cause is a project name other than `exterprise`. Fix it under **Settings → Build → Edit**, then **Retry deployment**.

Part 6. Turn on preview builds for branches

☐ **6.1** Open the **exterprise** Worker → **Settings** tab → **Build** section.

☐ **6.2** Under **Branch control**, make sure **Builds for non-production branches** is **enabled** → **Save**.

> ✔ **You should see:** a production branch of `main`, with non-production builds enabled. From now on every pushed branch gets its own preview link.

Part 7. Test the site on the workers.dev address

Open `https://exterprise.<your-account>.workers.dev` and check each item:

☐ **7.1** The homepage loads: hero video, menu, scrolling sections.

☐ **7.2** **What We Do → ServiceNow** opens the ServiceNow page.

☐ **7.3** **About** and **Contact Us** open.

☐ **7.4** Add `/contact-us` to the end of the address. It should land on the **Contact** page.

☐ **7.5** Add `/this-page-does-not-exist`. The **"This page has moved or doesn't exist"** page appears.

☐ **7.6** Add `/robots.txt`. A text file appears.

☐ **7.7** Open the address on a **phone**. The layout fits and the menu opens.

> ✔ **You should see:** everything working. **Don't continue until Part 7 passes.**

Part 8. Switch the nameservers to Cloudflare (at your registrar)

Visitors still see the old site after this step. Only who answers DNS changes. Email keeps working because Part 4 copied the records.

☐ **8.1** **If DNSSEC was On in step 1.5, turn it OFF now**, and wait 15 minutes before 8.2:

- **GoDaddy: DNS** → **DNSSEC** → **Off** / delete the DS records
- **Namecheap: Advanced DNS** → **DNSSEC** → switch off
- **Others:** remove the **DS records** / turn DNSSEC off

☐ **8.2** Open the nameserver settings:

- **GoDaddy: My Products** → *exterprise.us* → **DNS** → **Nameservers** tab → **Change Nameservers** → **I'll use my own nameservers**
- **Namecheap: Domain List** → **Manage** → **Nameservers** → choose **Custom DNS**
- **Squarespace / Google Domains: DNS** → **Nameservers** → **Use custom nameservers**

☐ **8.3** Delete the existing nameservers and enter the **two Cloudflare nameservers** from step 4.6 → **Save**. Confirm if asked.

☐ **8.4** Back in Cloudflare (the tab from 4.6), click **Check nameservers now** / **Done, check nameservers**.

> ✔ **You should see:** the registrar showing only the two `…ns.cloudflare.com` nameservers.

Part 9. Wait for "Active", then check email

☐ **9.1** Wait for Cloudflare's email: **"exterprise.us is now active on a Cloudflare Free plan"**. This is usually under 1 hour and at most 24. In the dashboard, the domain shows **Active** with a green tick.

☐ **9.2** Send an email **to** contact@exterprise.us from a personal account → check it arrives → **reply** → check the reply arrives.

> ✔ **You should see: Active** status, and email working both ways.

> **If email fails:** in Cloudflare, go to **exterprise.us → DNS → Records** and compare with your Part 1 screenshot. Add any missing MX/TXT/CNAME record, with mail records set to **DNS only**.

Part 10. Go live: point the domain at the new site

Do this at the quiet time you planned. Visitors switch to the new site within about a minute.

☐ **10.1** Open **exterprise.us** → **DNS** → **Records**.

☐ **10.2** **Write down** (in the table at the top of this playbook) the **Type** and **Content** of:

- the record named `www`
- the record named `exterprise.us` (or `@`)

You need these if you ever roll back.

☐ **10.3** Delete only those two records. For each: **Edit** → **Delete** → confirm. **Don't delete MX, TXT or mail records.**

☐ **10.4** Go to **Compute (Workers) → Workers & Pages** → **exterprise** → **Settings** → **Domains & Routes** → **+ Add** → **Custom domain**.

☐ **10.5** Type `www.exterprise.us` → **Add domain**.

☐ **10.6** Again: **+ Add** → **Custom domain** → `exterprise.us` → **Add domain**.

☐ **10.7** Wait 1–5 minutes until both domains show **Active** and the certificate is ready.

✔ **You should see:** under **Domains & Routes**, both `www.exterprise.us` and `exterprise.us` listed as **Active**. Opening `https://www.exterprise.us` shows the **new** site. Use a private or incognito window to avoid your browser cache.

Part 11. Redirect exterprise.us → www.exterprise.us

☐ **11.1** Open **exterprise.us** → **Rules** → **Overview**.

☐ **11.2** Click **+ Create rule** → **Redirect Rule**, or under **Templates** choose **Redirect from Root to WWW** → **Use template**.

☐ **11.3** If you used the template, check the fields are filled like this. Otherwise fill them in:

Field	Value
Rule name	`Root to www`
When incoming requests match	**Wildcard pattern**, request URL: `https://exterprise.us/*`
Then: target URL	`https://www.exterprise.us/${1}`
Status code	**301**
Preserve query string	☑ ticked

☐ **11.4** Click **Deploy** / **Save**.

✔ **You should see:** `https://exterprise.us/about.html` opens `https://www.exterprise.us/about.html`.

Part 12. SSL / HTTPS settings

☐ **12.1** Open **exterprise.us** → **SSL/TLS** → **Overview** → **Configure** (or the encryption mode selector) → **Full (strict)** → **Save**.

☐ **12.2** Go to **SSL/TLS** → **Edge Certificates** and turn **ON**:

- **Always Use HTTPS**
- **Automatic HTTPS Rewrites**

☐ **12.3** On the same page, check **Minimum TLS Version** is **TLS 1.2**.

✔ **You should see:** `http://www.exterprise.us` (without the *s*) switching automatically to `https://`.

Part 13. Security, speed and analytics

☐ **13.1** Go to **exterprise.us** → **Security** → **Bots** (on newer menus, **Security → Settings**) and turn **Bot Fight Mode ON**.

☐ **13.2** On the same page, leave **Block AI Scrapers and Crawlers OFF**. Turning it on stops ChatGPT, Claude and Gemini from reading the site, which would reduce how often they recommend Exterprise.

☐ **13.3** Go to **Speed** → **Optimization** → **Content Optimization** and turn **Early Hints ON**.

☐ **13.4** In the left sidebar, go to **Analytics & Logs** → **Web Analytics** → **Add a site** → choose `www.exterprise.us` → **Done**. If it offers *automatic setup*, accept it; no code change is needed.

☐ **13.5** Re-enable **DNSSEC** (only if it was on before):

1. Go to **exterprise.us** → **DNS** → **Settings** → **DNSSEC** → **Enable DNSSEC**.
2. Copy the **DS record** values it shows.
3. Add them at your registrar's DNSSEC page.

> ✔ **You should see:** Bot Fight Mode on, Early Hints on, and Web Analytics showing visits within an hour.

Part 14. Final check (takes 5 minutes)

Use a private or incognito window:

☐ **14.1** `https://www.exterprise.us` shows the new homepage, with a padlock in the address bar.

☐ **14.2** `https://exterprise.us` redirects to `https://www.exterprise.us`.

☐ **14.3** `https://www.exterprise.us/servicenow.html`, `/about.html` and `/contact.html` load.

☐ **14.4** `https://www.exterprise.us/contact-us` lands on the Contact page.

☐ **14.5** `https://www.exterprise.us/sitemap.xml` and `/robots.txt` load.

☐ **14.6** The site works on a phone.

☐ **14.7** An email to contact@exterprise.us still arrives.

☐ **14.8** **Workers & Pages → exterprise → Deployments** shows the latest deployment as **Active / Success**.

🎉 **Live.** From now on, every merge to `main` on GitHub deploys automatically in about a minute.

Rollback card (keep this handy)

Problem	What to click
A bad website change	**Workers & Pages → exterprise → Deployments** → find the last good deployment → ⋯ → **Rollback** → confirm. Fixed in seconds.
Need the old website back	1. **Workers & Pages → exterprise → Settings → Domains & Routes** → remove both custom domains (⋯ → **Remove**). 2. **DNS → Records → + Add record** → re-create the two records you wrote down in step 10.2. 3. The old site returns within about 2 minutes.
Email stopped	**DNS → Records**: compare with your Part 1 screenshot, re-add missing MX/TXT/CNAME records, set to **DNS only**.
Site down everywhere	Check https://www.cloudflarestatus.com, then roll back as above.

After launch (same day)

☐ **Google Search Console** (https://search.google.com/search-console):

1. **Add property** → **Domain** → `exterprise.us` → **Continue**.
2. Choose **Verify with Cloudflare**, or copy the TXT record into **Cloudflare DNS → + Add record → TXT**.
3. Click **Verify**.
4. Go to **Sitemaps** → enter `sitemap.xml` → **Submit**.

☐ **Bing Webmaster Tools** (https://www.bing.com/webmasters): **Import** → **Google Search Console** → **Continue** → choose the property → **Import**.

☐ **GitHub Pages backup** (optional, after 2–4 weeks of stable running):

1. Open the **XVOXLABS/Exterprise** repo → **Settings** → **Pages**.
2. Either leave it on as a backup copy, or set **Source** to **None** to switch it off.